

Interview Preparation Guide — Project Manager

1. Methodology Knowledge

Agile/Scrum vs. Waterfall, when each fits, and practical scrum ceremonies (sprint planning, standups, retrospectives).

2. Stakeholder and Risk Management

Handling shifting requirements mid-sprint, communicating missed deadlines to leadership, and early risk identification.

3. Tooling

Jira/Trello/Asana for tracking, Confluence/Notion for documentation, and structuring boards for cross-functional teams.

Scenario-Based Questions

Scenario-based questions test applied judgment rather than textbook recall — interviewers are usually more interested in your reasoning process than the exact final answer.

Scenario: Two senior engineers on your team disagree strongly on technical approach and it's blocking sprint progress. How do you resolve it without overstepping into the technical decision yourself?

Scenario: A client adds a 'small' new requirement two days before a release. How do you handle the request and the timeline conversation?

Scenario: You discover mid-sprint that a task everyone assumed was 2 days of work is actually going to take 2 weeks. What do you do?

Questions by Experience Level

The bar for the same topic area rises sharply by level. Below is a representative question for a Project Manager at each tier, showing how depth of expected answer changes — not just difficulty of the question itself.

Intern: Q: What's the difference between a sprint and a milestone?

Entry-Level: Q: How would you structure a daily standup for a team of 6?

Associate Engineer: Q: How do you prioritize a backlog when three stakeholders each think their item is highest priority?

Engineer: Q: Design a risk register for a 6-month project with an external vendor dependency.

Senior: Q: How would you manage a project where the client relationship itself is strained, separate from the actual delivery risk?

Principal: Q: How would you set and evaluate delivery process standards across multiple PMs and multiple concurrent client projects?